

Outreach Scripts

Social posts bring in friends of friends. **Direct outreach brings in the steady clients.** The best early targets are businesses where one person being out stops things from running:

- **Small offices:** dentists, chiropractors, vets, insurance agents, real estate offices, law and accounting firms (tax season!), property managers
- **Schools:** main offices, athletic departments, PTOs, private and parochial schools, preschools
- **Churches and nonprofits:** events, mailings, office coverage
- **Local retail and boutiques:** holiday rush, inventory counts
- **Small contractors and trades:** the owner's spouse usually runs the office alone
- **Busy families and seniors:** organizing, errands, appointments, paperwork

Start with people she already knows: former colleagues, parents from school, her own dentist and insurance agent.

1. Introduction email to a business

Subject: A local backup for when someone's out

Hi [Name],

My name is Ashley Harris. I live in [town] and recently started **Your Backup Plan**, a flexible helping-hand service for local businesses in the South Hills and Washington County.

When someone calls off, an employee is out for a few days or weeks, or a project keeps getting pushed aside, I can step in for a few hours, a day, a week or a project. That includes front desk and phones, scheduling, data entry, filing, organizing, inventory and event help. There's no agency markup, no hiring paperwork and no long-term commitment.

I'd love to be the person you call the next time you're short-handed. I've attached my flyer. Could I stop by for five minutes to introduce myself, or would it be easier to just keep my number on file?

Thank you! Ashley Harris Your Backup Plan 412-401-3208 · yourbackupplan.ashley@gmail.com

2. Email to a school or district office

Subject: Office coverage help, from a former school staff member

Hi [Name],

I recently left my position at [school] and have started **Your Backup Plan**, providing flexible, short-term help for schools and offices in the South Hills and Washington County.

I know how quickly a school office falls behind when someone is out, and how busy registration, testing, picture day, events and the start and end of the year get. I'm comfortable with the front desk, attendance, phones, parents and students, and I can provide current PA clearances.

If you ever need a reliable extra set of hands for a day, a week or an event, I'd love to help. My flyer is attached.

Thank you, Ashley Harris · 412-401-3208

Note: many districts can only pay outside help through a vendor or substitute process. Ask the business office: "What do you need from me to be set up as a vendor?" (usually a W-9, proof of insurance and clearances).

3. Walk-in introduction (30 seconds)

Bring flyers and business cards. Go mid-morning Tuesday to Thursday, not Monday morning or lunch.

"Hi! I'm Ashley, I live right in [town]. I just started a local business called Your Backup Plan. Basically, when a business is short-handed (someone calls off, someone's on leave, or there's a project nobody has time for), I come in and cover it, for a few hours or a few weeks. No agency, no hiring. Could I leave a flyer for whoever handles the office? And is there a best person or email to follow up with?"

Write down the manager's name. Follow up by email within 2 days.

4. Follow-up (1–2 weeks later)

Subject: Quick follow-up, Your Backup Plan

Hi [Name],

Just a quick follow-up from when I stopped by [last week]. No need to reply. I just wanted my contact info to be easy to find the next time someone is out or a project piles up.

 412-401-3208 (call or text, including short notice)

Thanks, and have a great week! Ashley

5. Text to friends and family (share request)

Hi! I just launched my new business, Your Backup Plan 💡❤️ If you know any business owners, office managers, teachers/school staff or busy families who could use an extra set of hands, would you share my post or pass along my number? 412-401-3208. It means the world. Thank you!!

6. After the job: thank you + review request

Hi [Name]! Thank you so much for having me in this week. I really enjoyed helping out. If you were happy with my work, would you mind leaving a quick Google review? It helps other local businesses find me: [Google review link]

And please keep my number handy for next time! ❤️ Ashley

Get the review link from Google Business Profile → "Ask for reviews."

7. Referral thank-you

Thank you so much for referring [Name] to me! Referrals are the biggest compliment and the lifeblood of a small business. ❤️

Consider a small thank-you, such as a coffee gift card or one free hour of help, for referrals that turn into booked work.

8. Answering "What do you charge?"

"It depends on the kind of work. For most business and office help, it's \$[rate] an hour with a [3]-hour minimum, and I'm happy to give you a flat quote for a project. Tell me a little about what you need and I'll give you an exact number."

See the Pricing Guide for recommended rates.